GENTLE MONSTER × THE METROPOLITAN MUSEUM OF ART

NEW YORK MONSTER *at the Met*

“The sculpture joins the crowd.”

A limited eyewear drop for New York. Dainty silver frames take their shapes from the Met’s Egyptian, European and Oceanic collections. The campaign is the moment a sculpture puts the glasses on and looks back at the people who have spent centuries looking at it.

BRAND	Gentle Monster. Dainty metal eyewear, editorial and theatrical.
CAMPAIGN	New York Monster at the Met (working title). Line: “Look back.”
PRODUCT	Capsule collection of optical frames and sunglasses in fine silver metal. Three frame families, one hero model.
HERO ARTWORK	Perseus with the Head of Medusa (Canova), The Met. The sculpture that wears the frame.
LAUNCH	Spring 2027, New York City.
HERO MEDIA	Huge banners flanking the Met’s Fifth Avenue entrance, paired with a short film and a social series.
PREPARED BY	Maria Haceaturian, Creative Director · A.I. for Designers (ART 3041)

01 Why this, why now

Gentle Monster treats a retail space like a stage and a campaign like a short film. The Met is the city’s largest stage for objects people stand and stare at. Both brands ask a single question of their audience: what are you looking at, and what does it do to you?

New York gets a drop that belongs to it. The Met itself becomes the set, and a museum visit becomes the launch event.

02 The insight

In a museum everyone is looking and nothing looks back. Eyewear is how we look. So when the art puts on glasses, it stops being looked at and starts looking.

03 The big idea

The sculpture joins the crowd. A visitor in a pair of frames and a sculpture in the same pair, seen across the entrance of the Met. Same frame, same stare, five thousand years apart.

04 Audience

Primary

New Yorkers aged 20–40 who go to museums, galleries and openings, follow fashion closely and treat eyewear as an accessory worth owning. Students, designers, creatives.

Secondary

Met members, collectors and visitors from out of town who want something from New York that isn't a tote bag. Gentle Monster fans who follow its collaborations.

05 The collection

Three frame families, each taken from a Met department. All are ultra-fine metal with a silver finish, scaled up or down as needed, with matching sunglasses. Names are working titles.

EGYPT · "KOHL"	Long almond lens with an upswept outer corner that follows the painted eye line of Egyptian portraits. The profile line, in wire.
EUROPE · "PERSEUS"	Hero model. Slim oval lens, bridge shaped like a laurel leaf, temple ends that fall like marble drapery. Sized to look right on the sculpture's face.
OCEANIA · "LASHING"	Round lens with fine wrapped bindings at the hinge and bridge, after the lashed fibre in carved Oceanic works.
SUNGLASSES	The same three silhouettes with smoke, pale bronze and clear-silver lenses.
PACKAGING	Marble-cream case with a plinth-style label card that names the object each frame was drawn from.

06 The campaign

HERO BANNERS	A diptych on both sides of the Met's entrance. Left: a visitor in a pair, looking right. Right: Perseus in the same pair, looking left. Between them, the people walking in.
FILM · 45S	Visitors drift through the Egyptian, European and Oceanic galleries in different frames. Motion blur, then silence. The camera pans to Perseus, who wears the pair. Cut to line: "Look back." Cut-downs at 15s and 6s.
SOCIAL	"Pairs": a visitor and a sculpture, one frame, one post. A new pair each week through the launch.
STREET	The banner pair is echoed on subway platforms and bus shelters near the Met and the Gentle Monster stores, with one frame per placement.
RETAIL	Window installations that put a sculpture-scale pair of glasses on a plinth, with the label card beside it.

07 Tone of voice

Dry, curious, a little theatrical. Short lines. It talks about art like a friend who knows a lot and doesn't show off. Gentle, as the name says. Never loud.

Sounds like

"Look back."
"Same frame. Five thousand years apart."
"Perseus doesn't need a prescription."
"Everyone's looking. Now so is the art."

Doesn't sound like

"Shop the drop now!"
"Art meets fashion."
Exclamation marks, puns on "see", anything that explains the joke.

08 Look and feel (full detail in the style guide)

- **Palette:** marble cream, limestone, sandstone, aged silver and patina black. One muted accent per department: faience blue for Egypt, oxblood for Europe, ochre for Oceania.
- **Type:** Fraunces Light in capitals for the name, Bodoni italic for "at the Met", Inter for everything small.
- **Pictures:** real galleries, real light, one human among the stone. A crowd in motion against a still sculpture. Fine metal in sharp focus on a calm ground.

09 Mandatories and cautions

- The Gentle Monster and Met marks appear only as supplied by each brand. This concept uses a text line, "Gentle Monster × The Metropolitan Museum of Art", as a stand-in.
- This is a student concept for coursework. It is not an announced partnership, and the Met has not approved it. Any real use of its building, banners or artworks would need the museum's permission.
- The sculpture is shown wearing glasses in an edited image. It isn't physically altered, and the campaign never suggests that it is.

10 Timeline (proposed)

LATE FEBRUARY 2027	Teaser: the empty plinth, a frame, no explanation.
MID MARCH 2027	Banners go up. Film and social series begin.
APRIL 2027	Drop goes on sale at Gentle Monster stores and online. Weekly "Pairs" release.
MAY 2027	Installation closes. Wrap-up film.

11 How we'll know it worked

- People photograph the banners, and the pair travels as a single image.
- "Pairs" posts get shared and recreated with visitors' own frames.
- The capsule sells through in New York first.

12 A.I. direction

Every asset in this package (brief, style guide, moodboard layout, logomark and frame drawings) was produced by A.I. under my direction. Photographs in the moodboard are reference images I collected. See the disclosure in the style guide.